



OFFICE OF THE CONVENER · THE SECRETARIAT

# African Global Queens Summit

United Kingdom · 14–31 August 2026

## Event Hall Risk Assessment

INTERNATIONAL CULTURAL, LEADERSHIP & HUMANITARIAN SUMMIT

**Event:** African Global Queens Summit

**Venue:** Porchester Hall

**Event Date:** 23 August 2026

**Responsible Person / Organiser:** Marie Erete

**Assessment Date:** 22 August 2026

**Maximum Attendance:** Up to 200 persons

**Address:** Porchester Road, Bayswater, London W2 5HS

**Event Time:** 10:00 am – 11:00 pm

**Venue Manager:** SarahJane

**Review Date:** 25 August 2026

### I. Purpose of this Risk Assessment

This Risk Assessment has been prepared for the African Global Queens Summit taking place at Porchester Hall, Bayswater, London.

The event is expected to accommodate up to **200 attendees** and will include African Queens, Traditional Rulers, Royal Consorts, dignitaries, invited guests, speakers, cultural performers, event staff, volunteers and members of the public.

The purpose of this assessment is to identify foreseeable risks associated with the event and to establish appropriate measures to protect attendees, staff, performers, dignitaries, contractors and venue personnel.

Porchester Hall is a Grade II listed historic venue and is regularly used for public events, ceremonies, concerts and other functions.

This assessment should be read alongside the venue's own fire risk assessment, emergency procedures, capacity arrangements, licensing requirements, insurance requirements and health and safety procedures.

## 2. Event Management

**Responsible Person:** Marie Erete — with overall responsibility for coordinating the event from the organiser's side and for ensuring that the measures identified in this assessment are implemented.

**Venue Manager:** SarahJane — responsible for venue-specific matters, including the venue's emergency procedures, fire safety systems, building safety, access arrangements and liaison with venue staff.

All event staff and volunteers should receive a briefing before the event covering:

- Emergency procedures;
- Fire evacuation;
- Location of emergency exits;
- First aid arrangements;
- Security procedures;
- Crowd management;
- Safeguarding;
- Incident reporting; and
- Procedures for dealing with emergencies.

## 3. Risk Rating

| LIKELIHOOD        | SEVERITY            |
|-------------------|---------------------|
| 1 – Very unlikely | 1 – Minor injury    |
| 2 – Unlikely      | 2 – Moderate injury |
| 3 – Possible      | 3 – Serious injury  |
| 4 – Likely        | 4 – Major injury    |
| 5 – Very likely   | 5 – Fatality        |

**Risk Rating = Likelihood × Severity**

| Rating | Risk Level | Action Required                                |
|--------|------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1–4    | Low        | Maintain existing controls                     |
| 5–9    | Medium     | Additional controls should be considered       |
| 10–16  | High       | Further controls required                      |
| 17–25  | Very High  | Event should not proceed until risk is reduced |

## 4. Fire and Emergency Evacuation

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HAZARD: FIRE, SMOKE, ELECTRICAL OR COOKING FIRE, OR ANOTHER EMERGENCY REQUIRING EVACUATION

INITIAL RISK: HIGH

**Persons at Risk:** All attendees, staff, performers, dignitaries, contractors and venue personnel.

### CONTROL MEASURES

- The venue's current Fire Risk Assessment and emergency procedures must be confirmed with the Venue Manager.
- All emergency exits must remain accessible and unobstructed.
- Emergency escape routes must remain clear throughout the event.
- Fire exits must not be used for storage or equipment.
- Fire alarm systems must be operational.
- Fire extinguishers must be accessible and appropriately maintained.
- Emergency lighting must be operational.
- Event decorations must not obstruct escape routes.
- Event staff will be briefed on the evacuation procedure.
- The designated assembly point will be confirmed with the Venue Manager before guests arrive.
- No person will be permitted to exceed the venue's approved capacity.
- Emergency access for the emergency services must be maintained.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 5. Crowd Management and Capacity

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HAZARD: OVERCROWDING, CONGESTION, PUSHING, FALLS OR DIFFICULTY EVACUATING

INITIAL RISK: HIGH

**Maximum Attendance:** 200 persons

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Attendance will be monitored throughout the event.
- The maximum permitted venue capacity will not be exceeded.
- Entrance and exit points will be monitored.
- Gangways and circulation areas will remain clear.
- Tables and chairs will be positioned to maintain safe circulation.
- Event stewards will monitor movement around entrances, exits and the main hall.
- Any VIP or Royal Procession will be managed by designated stewards.
- Queues will be managed in an orderly manner.
- Emergency exits will not be obstructed by guests, equipment or displays.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW

## 6. Slips, Trips and Falls

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HAZARD: LOOSE CABLES, WET FLOORS, BAGS, EQUIPMENT, UNEVEN SURFACES OR OBSTRUCTIONS

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Cables will be routed away from pedestrian areas wherever possible.
- Cable covers will be used where cables cross walkways.
- Spillages will be cleaned immediately.
- Bags and personal belongings must not obstruct aisles.
- Walkways must remain clear.
- Stage steps must remain unobstructed.
- Lighting must be adequate throughout the venue.
- Staff will report and address hazards immediately.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW

## 7. Stage and Performance Area

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HAZARD: FALLS FROM THE STAGE, UNSTABLE EQUIPMENT, CABLES OR PERFORMER INJURY

### CONTROL MEASURES

- The stage must be inspected before use.
- Stage access steps must be secure.
- Stage edges should be clearly visible.
- Speakers, microphones, lighting and other technical equipment must be safely positioned.
- Equipment must not obstruct emergency routes.
- Only authorised personnel should enter technical areas.
- Performers should be briefed regarding stage access.
- Heavy equipment must be securely positioned.
- No person should stand on chairs, tables or unstable equipment.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 8. Cultural Performances and Royal Processions

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HAZARD: COLLISION, FALLS, COSTUME-RELATED ACCIDENTS, CONGESTION OR PERFORMER-GUEST INTERACTION

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Performance areas will be clearly identified.
- Performers will be briefed before the event.
- Adequate space will be maintained for cultural performances.
- Props must be safe and suitable for indoor use.
- Performers will not enter occupied seating areas except where specifically planned.
- Royal and cultural processions will be supervised by designated event stewards.
- Traditional costumes must not create trip hazards.
- Any children involved in performances must be appropriately supervised.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 9. VIPs, Queens and Dignitaries

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HAZARD: UNAUTHORISED ACCESS, CROWDING, SECURITY INCIDENTS OR DISRUPTION TO OFFICIAL PROCEEDINGS

### CONTROL MEASURES

- VIP areas will be clearly identified.
- Access to restricted areas will be controlled.
- Security / stewards will be briefed regarding VIP movements.
- Royal processions will be planned in advance.
- Unauthorised persons will not be permitted into restricted areas.
- VIP evacuation arrangements will form part of the overall emergency plan.
- Event staff will maintain appropriate professional boundaries and discretion when dealing with dignitaries.

RESIDUAL RISK: MEDIUM

## 10. Security and Unauthorised Access

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HAZARD: UNAUTHORISED ENTRY, THEFT, DISORDERLY BEHAVIOUR, HARASSMENT OR DELIBERATE DISRUPTION

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Entrances will be monitored.
- Event staff / security will monitor access points.
- Restricted areas will be controlled.
- Suspicious or unattended items will be reported immediately.
- Security personnel will be used where appropriate.
- Staff will not unnecessarily confront an aggressive or potentially dangerous individual.
- Emergency services will be contacted where required.
- Any significant security incident will be recorded.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 11. Medical Emergency and First Aid

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HAZARD: INJURY, ILLNESS, FAINTING, FALLS, ALLERGIC REACTION OR OTHER MEDICAL EMERGENCY

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Appropriate first aid provision will be available.
- The location of first aid equipment will be communicated to event staff.
- Emergency services will be contacted where necessary.
- Access for an ambulance must remain unobstructed.
- The location of the nearest defibrillator should be confirmed before the event.
- Significant accidents and injuries will be recorded.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 12. Food and Catering

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HAZARD: FOOD POISONING, ALLERGIC REACTIONS, BURNS, SPILLS OR CONTAMINATION

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Catering will be undertaken by competent food handlers.
- Appropriate food hygiene procedures must be followed.
- Allergens must be identified.
- Dietary requirements should be communicated to the caterer.
- Hot food and beverages must be handled safely.
- Catering equipment must not obstruct escape routes.
- Food and beverage spills must be cleaned immediately.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW

## 13. Electrical Equipment and AV

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HAZARD: ELECTRIC SHOCK, FIRE, EQUIPMENT FAILURE OR TRIP HAZARDS

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Electrical equipment must be suitable for the intended use.
- Cables and plugs will be inspected before use.
- Damaged equipment must not be used.
- Extension leads must not be overloaded.
- Cables must be secured.
- Lighting, speakers, screens and other equipment must be securely positioned.
- Technical equipment should be operated by competent personnel.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW

## 14. Accessibility

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HAZARD: DIFFICULTY ACCESSING THE VENUE OR EVACUATING SAFELY FOR PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES, ELDERLY PERSONS OR PERSONS WITH MOBILITY DIFFICULTIES

### CONTROL MEASURES

- Accessible routes must remain unobstructed.
- Accessible toilets / facilities should be available.
- Seating arrangements will accommodate persons with mobility requirements.
- Staff will assist persons requiring assistance where appropriate.
- Emergency evacuation arrangements will take accessibility requirements into account.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW

## 15. Safeguarding

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HAZARD: HARASSMENT, INAPPROPRIATE BEHAVIOUR, EXPLOITATION OR HARM INVOLVING CHILDREN OR VULNERABLE PERSONS

### CONTROL MEASURES

- A designated safeguarding contact will be identified.
- Staff and volunteers will be briefed on safeguarding concerns.
- Children should remain under the responsibility of their parent / guardian unless specific arrangements have been made.
- Safeguarding concerns must be reported immediately to the responsible person and, where necessary, the appropriate authorities.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 16. Lost Children or Vulnerable Persons

### CONTROL MEASURES

- A designated member of staff will deal with lost-child incidents.
- A lost child or vulnerable person must not simply be left unattended.
- Parents or guardians must be appropriately identified before a child is released.
- Personal information must be handled sensitively.
- Any safeguarding concern must be escalated immediately.

## 17. Alcohol and Intoxication

Where alcohol is served:

- Consumption will be responsibly managed.
- The venue's licensing conditions must be complied with.
- Staff will monitor excessive consumption.
- Disorderly behaviour will be dealt with promptly.
- Intoxicated persons will not be permitted to create a danger to themselves or others.
- Alcohol will not be served to persons under the legal age.

RESIDUAL RISK: LOW / MEDIUM

## 18. Emergency Contact Information

- Emergency Services:** 999
- Venue:** Porchester Hall — Porchester Road, Bayswater, London W2 5HS
- Responsible Person:** Marie Erete
- Venue Manager:** SarahJane
- Event Safety Lead:** Queen Imwiko
- First Aid Lead:** Marie Erete
- Security Lead:** Cecilia Merody
- Safeguarding Lead:** Max Chamberlin
- Evacuation Co-ordinator:** Mary Erete Brown
- Emergency Assembly Point:** The garden opposite the venue



## 19. Evacuation Procedure

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In the event of fire or another emergency requiring evacuation:

1. The alarm will be raised.
2. Event staff will instruct attendees to remain calm.
3. Guests will be directed to the nearest safe emergency exit.
4. Personal belongings should not be collected.
5. Staff will assist persons requiring additional assistance.
6. Attendees will proceed to the designated assembly point.
7. The Responsible Person or Venue Manager will contact emergency services where necessary.
8. No person will re-enter the building until authorised.
9. Any missing person will be reported immediately to the person coordinating the evacuation.

**Assembly Point:** The garden opposite the venue. Evacuation co-ordinated by Mary Erete Brown.

## 20. Pre-Event Safety Check

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The following checks should be completed before guests are admitted:

- |                                                            |                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Venue capacity confirmed          | <input type="checkbox"/> AV equipment safely installed          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Fire exits checked                | <input type="checkbox"/> Cables secured                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Escape routes clear               | <input type="checkbox"/> Seating safely arranged                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Emergency lighting checked        | <input type="checkbox"/> Accessible routes checked              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Fire alarm arrangements confirmed | <input type="checkbox"/> Toilets operational                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Fire extinguishers accessible     | <input type="checkbox"/> Security arrangements confirmed        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Assembly point confirmed          | <input type="checkbox"/> Catering arrangements confirmed        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> First aid provision confirmed     | <input type="checkbox"/> Staff and volunteers briefed           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Defibrillator location confirmed  | <input type="checkbox"/> Emergency contacts circulated          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Emergency access maintained       | <input type="checkbox"/> Maximum attendance confirmed           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Stage inspected                   | <input type="checkbox"/> Venue licence and conditions confirmed |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Electrical equipment checked      |                                                                 |

## 21. Overall Risk Assessment

Subject to the implementation of the control measures contained within this document, the overall risk associated with holding the African Global Queens Summit for up to **200 persons** is assessed as:

**LOW TO MEDIUM**

The event may proceed provided that the venue's safety requirements, fire procedures, capacity restrictions, licensing conditions and emergency arrangements are satisfied.

The risk assessment should be reviewed if there is any significant change to the number of attendees, venue layout, entertainment, catering, security arrangements, technical equipment or other circumstances affecting safety.

## 22. Declaration

I confirm that this risk assessment has been prepared for the African Global Queens Summit and that reasonable measures will be implemented to manage the foreseeable risks associated with the event.

**Responsible Person**  
**Name:** Marie Erete  
**Position:** Event Organiser / Responsible Person  
  
**Signature:**  
  
  
**Date:** 22 August 2026

**Venue Representative**  
**Name:** SarahJane  
**Position:** Venue Manager  
  
**Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_  
  
**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Review**  
**Review Date:** 25 August 2026

**Reviewed By:** \_\_\_\_\_  
  
**Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_

